

which can then be redeemed for stays elsewhere. The platform also offers a premium tier, the Home Collection, which features luxury properties for \$1,000 a year. Home Collection only has around 2,000 listed homes.

CLOSED LOOP

While you may not be very comfortable handing over your keys to a stranger, the safeguards are reassuring. HomeExchange operates as a members-only community, where each participant is both a guest and a host. Intensive communication precedes an agreement, bolstered by reviews, ratings, and clear expectations.

“It’s a closed community, because to be on the platform, you have to have some property listed,” says Arnaud. That closed loop builds a sense of trust. The reassurance extends to protection: property damage coverage of up to \$1 million ensures even the most carefully chosen *objets d’art* are safe. On the other hand, if you land at someone’s house and there are problems with the place like poor Wi-Fi, plumbing etc, HomeExchange will put you up in a hotel, ensuring that your holiday is not wasted.

HomeExchange is aiming to integrate 3,000 to 5,000 Indian homes within the first year. As of now, it has 130 members and 700 listings, clustered in metro cities—Mumbai, Delhi-NCR, Bengaluru—as well as perennial favourites like Goa, Jaipur, and Dehradun.

Early adopters are young, tech-savvy professionals looking for immersive ways to explore the world. Unlike Europe, where the community skews toward middle-class families, or the US, where it leans upper-class, India’s pioneers are digital nomads, software engineers, start-up founders—all eager to explore beyond the confines of hotels.

Arnaud sees India as a natural candidate for expansion. “Airbnb’s market

